AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

AA100B
The Arts Past and Present II

Main - All Branches
Final Exam

2024-2025/Fall Semester
Date: 15 Jan. 2025
4:30 – 7:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 Hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

This exam consists of TWO PARTS.

PART 1 contains 3 SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

PART 2 contains 3 ESSAY QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

AOU EGYPT

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. What is the study of **ethics**, and why is it important in **moral philosophy**?
2. What makes **Stonehenge** a **sacred place**, and what are some theories about its purpose and significance?
3. What is the significance of **the Sabine Hills Villa** in Roman history?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(40 points= 20 points for each essay)

Please choose TWO of the essay prompts below and write comprehensive responses in essay format. Your essays should be around 350 words each, covering all relevant aspects of the questions and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essays with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. How do **Epicurus's views on 'ataraxia' and desire** compare to **Aristotle's ideas about 'eudaimonia' and the 'function argument,'** and what are the key differences in their perspectives on **the ultimate objective of human life**?
   Your answer must address the following questions:
   a. What does Epicurus mean by ataraxia, and why is it important for his philosophy? How does it relate to the management of desires?
   b. How does Aristotle define eudaimonia, and what role does the function argument play in his ethical framework?
   c. How do Epicurus and Aristotle differ in their views about the value of leisure? What types of leisure activities do they each consider important?
   d. What is Epicurus's perspective on desires and their role in achieving happiness? How does this compare to Aristotle's view on fulfilling human potential?
   e. What do both philosophers see as the ultimate objective of human life, and how do their conclusions reflect their different ethical systems?

ASE EXPT

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5. Examine the phenomenon of **Milton Keynes**, a new town conceived in 1967 and continually expanding, being regarded as a **'sacred place'** by certain individuals or groups. Investigate the reasons behind this perception, considering the cultural, social, and spiritual factors that contribute to its significance. Analyze the symbolism and meanings attributed to Milton Keynes as a sacred place. Support your argument with specific details from the course material.

   Your answer must address the following questions:

   a. What similarities exist between Milton Keynes and ancient sites like Stonehenge and Avebury, particularly in terms of their layout and perceived significance?

   b. How do the street names in Milton Keynes reflect cultural or historical themes, and what significance do they hold for residents regarding its status as a sacred place?

   c. In what ways do the alignments of streets in Milton Keynes echo ancient knowledge or practices, and how might this contribute to the perception of the town as sacred?

   d. How does John Mitchell's book ***The View Over Atlantis*** inform the understanding of Milton Keynes as a sacred place, and what ancient knowledge does he suggest is relevant to its design?

   e. What specific symbols or meanings are attributed to Milton Keynes that link it to ancient wisdom, and how do these contribute to its recognition as a sacred space by certain groups?

6. To fully understand what **leisure** meant to the rich **Roman villa** owners, we must closely examine the **art** they chose to decorate their rooms and gardens with. Elaborate on the **different genres of art** used in Roman villas. To support your argument, use specific details from the course material.

   Your answer must address the following questions:

   a. What different genres of art were commonly used in Roman villas, and what purposes did they serve in the decoration of rooms and gardens?

   b. What themes or subjects are often depicted in the artwork found in Roman villas, and how do these reflect the values and interests of the villa owners?

   c. What symbolic meanings can be found in the art chosen by Roman villa owners, and how did these symbols enhance the overall atmosphere of the villas?

   d. How did the presence of art in Roman villas contribute to the leisure experience of the owners and their guests? What role did it play in their social and cultural lives?

   e. How can we evaluate the accuracy and authenticity of the information conveyed through art?

End of the Exam!

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